

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12399545
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
Inventor(s)	Chen; Wei Chih et al.

Power management watchdog

Abstract

An embodiment of an integrated circuit may comprise a circuit block and a power management circuit coupled to the circuit block to manage two or more power states for the circuit block and to manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, set a watchdog timer in response to the request, and monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state. Other embodiments are disclosed and claimed.

Inventors: Chen; Wei Chih (New Taipei, TW), Loh; Thiam Wah (Singapore, SG), Chang; Wei Shun (Taipei, TW)

Applicant: Intel Corporation (Santa Clara, CA)

Family ID: 1000008782871

Assignee: Intel Corporation (Santa Clara, CA)

Appl. No.: 17/550197

Filed: December 14, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230185349 A1	Jun. 15, 2023

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F1/00 (20060101); G06F1/14 (20060101); G06F1/28 (20060101); G06F1/3203 (20190101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06F1/28** (20130101); **G06F1/14** (20130101); G06F1/3203 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06F (1/28); G06F (1/14); G06F (1/3203); G06F (1/3228); G06F (1/3246); G06F (1/3287); G06F (11/0757); G06F (11/0754); G06F (1/3206); Y02D (10/00)

USPC: 713/320

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
5339437	12/1993	Yuen	714/E11.14	G06F 1/3203
6463001	12/2001	Williams	365/189.12	G06F 13/1636
9760158	12/2016	Weissmann	N/A	G06F 1/3287
2008/0052543	12/2007	Sokorac	713/300	G06F 1/3228
2009/0070607	12/2008	Safford	713/320	G06F 1/3234
2015/0355705	12/2014	Weissmann	713/320	G06F 1/324
2016/0205625	12/2015	Stojanovski	370/311	H04W 76/27
2017/0010933	12/2016	Wang	N/A	G06F 11/0757
2017/0371402	12/2016	Cooper	N/A	G06F 1/206
2018/0113764	12/2017	Bhandari	N/A	G06F 11/0712
2018/0336111	12/2017	Gendler	N/A	G06F 1/3287

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Extended European Search Report from European Patent Application No. 22206107.9 notified May 12, 2023, 10 pgs. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Derose; Volvick

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Essential Patents Group, LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(1) This disclosure generally relates to power management technology, and watchdog technology.

2. Background Art

(2) In the computer field, a watchdog timer refers to an electronic or software timer that is used to detect and recover from computer malfunctions. Watchdog timers may be utilized to automatically correct various hardware faults, to prevent malfunctioning or malicious software from disrupting system operation, etc. During normal operation, the computer regularly restarts the watchdog timer to prevent the timer from timing out or expiring. If the watchdog timer expires (e.g., the computer fails to restart the watchdog due to a hardware fault or program error), the watchdog timer will

generate a timeout signal to initiate corrective actions. Various controllers may include an integrated, on-chip watchdog timer.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The various embodiments of the present invention are illustrated by way of example, and not by way of limitation, in the figures of the accompanying drawings and in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an example of an integrated circuit (IC) according to an embodiment;
- (3) FIGS. 2A to 2B are illustrative diagrams of an example of a method according to an embodiment;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an example of an apparatus according to an embodiment;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of an example of a workflow according to an embodiment;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of an example of a computer system according to an embodiment;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example of a die of a system-on-a-chip (SOC) according to an embodiment;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a block diagram of an example of a system according to an embodiment;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of another example of a computer system according to an embodiment;
- (10) FIG. 9A is a block diagram illustrating both an exemplary in-order pipeline and an exemplary register renaming, out-of-order issue/execution pipeline according to embodiments of the invention;
- (11) FIG. 9B is a block diagram illustrating both an exemplary embodiment of an in-order architecture core and an exemplary register renaming, out-of-order issue/execution architecture core to be included in a processor according to embodiments of the invention;
- (12) FIGS. 10A-B illustrate a block diagram of a more specific exemplary in-order core architecture, which core would be one of several logic blocks (including other cores of the same type and/or different types) in a chip;
- (13) FIG. 11 is a block diagram of a processor that may have more than one core, may have an integrated memory controller, and may have integrated graphics according to embodiments of the invention;
- (14) FIGS. 12-15 are block diagrams of exemplary computer architectures; and
- (15) FIG. 16 is a block diagram contrasting the use of a software instruction converter to convert binary instructions in a source instruction set to binary instructions in a target instruction set according to embodiments of the invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (16) Embodiments discussed herein variously provide techniques and mechanisms for a power management watchdog. The technologies described herein may be implemented in one or more electronic devices. Non-limiting examples of electronic devices that may utilize the technologies described herein include any kind of mobile device and/or stationary device, such as cameras, cell phones, computer terminals, desktop computers, electronic readers, facsimile machines, kiosks, laptop computers, netbook computers, notebook computers, internet devices, payment terminals, personal digital assistants, media players and/or recorders, servers (e.g., blade server, rack mount server, combinations thereof, etc.), set-top boxes, smart phones, tablet personal computers, ultra-mobile personal computers, wired telephones, combinations thereof, and the like. More generally, the technologies described herein may be employed in any of a variety of electronic devices including integrated circuitry which is operable to provide a power management watchdog.
- (17) In the following description, numerous details are discussed to provide a more thorough

explanation of the embodiments of the present disclosure. It will be apparent to one skilled in the art, however, that embodiments of the present disclosure may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form, rather than in detail, in order to avoid obscuring embodiments of the present disclosure.

(18) Note that in the corresponding drawings of the embodiments, signals are represented with lines. Some lines may be thicker, to indicate a greater number of constituent signal paths, and/or have arrows at one or more ends, to indicate a direction of information flow. Such indications are not intended to be limiting. Rather, the lines are used in connection with one or more exemplary embodiments to facilitate easier understanding of a circuit or a logical unit. Any represented signal, as dictated by design needs or preferences, may actually comprise one or more signals that may travel in either direction and may be implemented with any suitable type of signal scheme.

(19) Throughout the specification, and in the claims, the term “connected” means a direct connection, such as electrical, mechanical, or magnetic connection between the things that are connected, without any intermediary devices. The term “coupled” means a direct or indirect connection, such as a direct electrical, mechanical, or magnetic connection between the things that are connected or an indirect connection, through one or more passive or active intermediary devices. The term “circuit” or “module” may refer to one or more passive and/or active components that are arranged to cooperate with one another to provide a desired function. The term “signal” may refer to at least one current signal, voltage signal, magnetic signal, or data/clock signal. The meaning of “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references. The meaning of “in” includes “in” and “on.”

(20) The term “device” may generally refer to an apparatus according to the context of the usage of that term. For example, a device may refer to a stack of layers or structures, a single structure or layer, a connection of various structures having active and/or passive elements, etc. Generally, a device is a three-dimensional structure with a plane along the x-y direction and a height along the z direction of an x-y-z Cartesian coordinate system. The plane of the device may also be the plane of an apparatus which comprises the device.

(21) The term “scaling” generally refers to converting a design (schematic and layout) from one process technology to another process technology and subsequently being reduced in layout area. The term “scaling” generally also refers to downsizing layout and devices within the same technology node. The term “scaling” may also refer to adjusting (e.g., slowing down or speeding up—i.e. scaling down, or scaling up respectively) of a signal frequency relative to another parameter, for example, power supply level.

(22) The terms “substantially,” “close,” “approximately,” “near,” and “about,” generally refer to being within $\pm 10\%$ of a target value. For example, unless otherwise specified in the explicit context of their use, the terms “substantially equal,” “about equal” and “approximately equal” mean that there is no more than incidental variation between among things so described. In the art, such variation is typically no more than $\pm 10\%$ of a predetermined target value.

(23) It is to be understood that the terms so used are interchangeable under appropriate circumstances such that the embodiments of the invention described herein are, for example, capable of operation in other orientations than those illustrated or otherwise described herein.

(24) Unless otherwise specified the use of the ordinal adjectives “first,” “second,” and “third,” etc., to describe a common object, merely indicate that different instances of like objects are being referred to and are not intended to imply that the objects so described must be in a given sequence, either temporally, spatially, in ranking or in any other manner.

(25) The terms “left,” “right,” “front,” “back,” “top,” “bottom,” “over,” “under,” and the like in the description and in the claims, if any, are used for descriptive purposes and not necessarily for describing permanent relative positions. For example, the terms “over,” “under,” “front side,” “back side,” “top,” “bottom,” “over,” “under,” and “on” as used herein refer to a relative position of one component, structure, or material with respect to other referenced components, structures or

materials within a device, where such physical relationships are noteworthy. These terms are employed herein for descriptive purposes only and predominantly within the context of a device z-axis and therefore may be relative to an orientation of a device. Hence, a first material “over” a second material in the context of a figure provided herein may also be “under” the second material if the device is oriented upside-down relative to the context of the figure provided. In the context of materials, one material disposed over or under another may be directly in contact or may have one or more intervening materials. Moreover, one material disposed between two materials may be directly in contact with the two layers or may have one or more intervening layers. In contrast, a first material “on” a second material is in direct contact with that second material. Similar distinctions are to be made in the context of component assemblies.

(26) The term “between” may be employed in the context of the z-axis, x-axis or y-axis of a device. A material that is between two other materials may be in contact with one or both of those materials, or it may be separated from both of the other two materials by one or more intervening materials. A material “between” two other materials may therefore be in contact with either of the other two materials, or it may be coupled to the other two materials through an intervening material. A device that is between two other devices may be directly connected to one or both of those devices, or it may be separated from both of the other two devices by one or more intervening devices.

(27) As used throughout this description, and in the claims, a list of items joined by the term “at least one of” or “one or more of” can mean any combination of the listed terms. For example, the phrase “at least one of A, B or C” can mean A; B; C; A and B; A and C; B and C; or A, B and C. It is pointed out that those elements of a figure having the same reference numbers (or names) as the elements of any other figure can operate or function in any manner similar to that described, but are not limited to such.

(28) In addition, the various elements of combinatorial logic and sequential logic discussed in the present disclosure may pertain both to physical structures (such as AND gates, OR gates, or XOR gates), or to synthesized or otherwise optimized collections of devices implementing the logical structures that are Boolean equivalents of the logic under discussion.

(29) In electronic design, a semiconductor intellectual property (IP) core (SIP core), IP core, or IP block may refer to a reusable unit of logic, cell, or integrated circuit (IC) layout design. For example, ICs such as application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), systems of field-programmable gate array (FPGA) logic, system-on-chips (SOCs), etc., may use IP blocks as part of an IC device design. As used herein, a circuit block refers to a unit of logic, cell, or integrated circuit (IC) layout design, and encompasses re-usable blocks such as IP blocks. The placement of the circuit blocks, routing, heatsink locations, etc., make up the physical layout characteristics of the IC device.

(30) With increased complexity of a computer system, SOC, platform, etc., high-power consumptions and stability may be a problem. For example, a software (SW) or hardware (HW) change may introduce an unanticipated increase in power consumption and/or reduction of battery life in such complex devices. For example, various power optimizations and/or stability verifications may be performed before a computer device/system is delivered to a user. Some later discovered problems after the system is placed into service may be attempted to be addressed by a SW and/or firmware (FW) update released to the user. One problem with conventional approaches to power management is that validation coverage is limited. Even with extensive validations, many of the user configurations in deployed applications that may affect a system's low power state may not be sufficiently considered. For example, a new unvalidated Universal Serial Bus (USB), thunderbolt, etc. device utilized by a user may block a controller from entering a low power state.

(31) Another problem with conventional approaches to power management is that there are numerous (e.g., almost unlimited) permutations of operating system (OS) and SW environments. After a computer device/system is delivered to the user and placed into service, new applications

and drivers are updated regularly, but the validation effort may be reduced. In addition, applications (e.g., such as antivirus SW) may also change the OS behavior. Such changes may cause unanticipated scenarios (e.g., corner cases) or misconfigurations on hardware devices that cause problems for the user such as reduced battery life. For example, software or hardware changes may cause unpredictable battery life because power management malfunctions may lead to thermal overrun. For example, after a notebook computer lid is closed by the user and the user puts the notebook computer inside a bag, if the system fails to enter a power saving mode then excessive heat may be generated inside the bag and the battery may drain. Such power management malfunction may cause premature aging of the battery due to the thermal stresses and higher charging cycle due to drained battery.

(32) With conventional power management technology, high-power consumption issues may be caused by devices or HW IP blocks not entering the correct low power state (e.g., as requested), due to untested scenarios, new hardware, new drivers, new use cases, etc. For example, an OS may request a driver to put a target device in a low power mode, but the OS does not know if the target device actually enters the requested lower power state. A device may be left in an active mode when the system is otherwise idle because of a wrong configuration or other issues, and the device cannot notify the OS/SW to take further actions for power saving when the system is otherwise idle. With a prematurely aged battery, a battery powered device may drain randomly and cannot guarantee function availability because various devices or circuit blocks do not properly enter the requested power saving state.

(33) Another problem with conventional power management technology is insufficient traceability of some power management issues. Without traces at a point of failure, addressing a power management issue is time consuming and difficult to debug. Some embodiments overcome one or more of the foregoing problems.

(34) Embodiments may provide power management with failsafe technology, that increases a probability that power management failure events may be resolved (e.g., even after SW, HW, or FW changes to a system). Embodiments of the failsafe technology may improve the user experience, because the user may experience fewer issues with unwarranted high power consumption, poor battery life, and/or premature aging of the battery. Embodiments of the failsafe technology may prevent power drains on all or most circuit blocks of a computer system and ensure that the circuit blocks always enter the requested power saving state properly (e.g., particularly circuit blocks that include the failsafe technology). Embodiments may also provide fine granularity trace (e.g., at a circuit block level) of power issues. Advantageously, embodiments may simplify debug of power issues with an IP block specific watchdog for power states that identifies a point of failure.

(35) Some embodiments provide technology for a power management watchdog (PMWD). Some embodiments provide PMWD technology at a circuit block granularity. For each hardware IP on a SOC, for example, a PMWD will be provided. If an embodiment of a hardware block with a PMWD fails to transit to a requested power state, the watchdog will generate an interrupt to inform the OS and the OS may act to properly handle the issue. Embodiments of the PMWD technology described herein may advantageously perform failsafe protections of critical energy resources (e.g., battery capacity) to avoid unwarranted high power consumption and/or poor device battery life. Embodiments of PMWD technology may also advantageously perform failsafe protections to avoid thermal overrun (e.g., complementing other power management techniques at a SOC level). Embodiments of PMWD technology may also advantageously more clearly identify a circuit block that is causing a power state fault (e.g., what circuit block(s) failed to transit) along with the states involved (e.g., HW IP “X” failed to transit from its current power state “A” to a requested power state “B”).

(36) Advantageously, some embodiments may provide an improved battery life experience, and may reduce or prevent a user from experiencing a low battery condition for unknown reasons.

Some embodiments of PMWD technology may be utilized to inform a user of a device/circuit block that is causing a power management problem, so that the user may act to correct the problem or replace the problematic device. Advantageously, some embodiments may provide improved power management that reduces a number of charging and discharging cycles of a battery, potentially improving the battery life.

(37) Suitable logic and/or circuitry to implement the PMWD technology described herein may be incorporated at any suitable location in a computer system. In some embodiments, the PMWD technology may be implemented as an independent power management circuit integrated with a circuit block. In some embodiments, a circuit block may include some type of controller and the PMWD technology may be integrated with the controller. Different electronic systems or platforms may include a variety of controllers including, for example, a memory controller (MC), a system management controller (SMC), a power management unit (PMU or P-Unit), a power control unit (PCU), a system management unit (SMU), a power management integrated circuit (PMIC), a baseboard management controller (BMC), etc., each of which may be a circuit block of the system/platform. A PCU, P-Unit, or PMIC may be implemented as a microcontroller that governs power and other functions of a system/platform (e.g., where the various functions may correspond to respective circuit blocks). For example, a P-unit/PMIC may include its own dedicated firmware/software, memory, a central processor unit (CPU), input/output (IO) functions, timers, analog-to-digital (A/D) converters, etc. In some systems, the PCU/P-Unit/PMIC may remain active even when the system is otherwise shut down.

(38) Although nominally referred to for its power management capabilities, the PCU/P-Unit/PMIC may also manage other functions such as IO, interfacing with built in keypads/touchpads, clock regulation, etc. Likewise, other management controllers that do not nominally refer to power management (e.g., a SMU, a SMC, a BMC), may also manage power or power-related functions. A BMC may also be implemented as a microcontroller, generally located on a motherboard of a system/platform (e.g., a server). The BMC may include its own firmware/memory/etc. and manages an interface between system-management software and platform hardware. In accordance with some embodiments, one or more of the foregoing example controllers, or circuit blocks within such controllers, may be further configured with the PMWD technology described herein to report a power state transition failure of a circuit block to an OS (e.g., to an OS power manager (OSPM)).

(39) With reference to FIG. 1, an embodiment of an integrated circuit **100** may include a circuit block **110**, and a power management circuit **120** coupled to the circuit block **110** to manage two or more power states for the circuit block **110** and to manage a request for the circuit block **110** to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, set a watchdog timer in response to the request, and monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block **110** from a current power state to the requested power state. In some embodiments, the power management circuit **120** may be further configured to report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires. The power management circuit **120** may also be configured to report an identification of the circuit block **110** together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires. The power management circuit **120** may also be configured to report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block **110** and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block **110** and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(40) In some embodiments, the power management circuit **120** may be additionally or alternatively configured to generate an interrupt to an OSPM that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires, and/or to force the circuit block **110** to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations or generated interrupts (e.g., after two or three watchdog timer timeouts or interrupts sent to the OSPM). For example, the power management circuit **120** may be configured to maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the

circuit block **110** to enter the requested power state, decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and generate an interrupt to an OSPM that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value. In some embodiments, further information such as the identification of the circuit block **110**, a current power state of the circuit block **110**, and the requested power state may be provided to the OSPM together with the interrupt.

(41) Embodiments of the circuit block **110** and/or power management circuit **120** may be incorporated in or integrated with a circuit block of any suitable controller of an electronic system/platform including, for example, a PCU, a PMIC, a P-Unit, a MC, etc. Although illustrated in FIG. 1 as being separate from the circuit block **110**, in some embodiments all or portion of the power management circuit **120** may be co-located with the circuit block **110**. Embodiments of the integrated circuit **100**, including the circuit block **110**, and/or the power management circuit **120**, may be integrated with any of the circuit blocks described herein including, for example, the processor **804** (FIG. 8), the cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** (FIG. 8), the control hub **832** (FIG. 8), the VR **814** (FIG. 8), the memory interface **834** (FIG. 8), the core **990** (FIG. 9B), the cores **1102A-N** (FIG. 11), the special purpose logic **1108** (FIG. 11), the IMCs **1114** (FIG. 11), the bus controller **1116** (FIG. 11), the processor **1210** (FIG. 12), the controller hub **1220** (FIG. 12; e.g., and/or the GMCH **1290** and the IOH **1250**), the co-processor **1245** (FIG. 12), the processor **1315** (FIG. 13), the processor **1370** (FIG. 13), the processor/coprocessor **1380** (FIG. 13), the coprocessor **1338** (FIG. 13), the chipset **1390** (FIG. 14), the coprocessor **1520** (FIG. 15), and/or the processors **1614**, **1616** (FIG. 16). In particular, embodiments of the power management circuit **120** may be incorporated in the PCU **810a,b** (FIG. 8), and/or the PMIC **812** (FIG. 8).

(42) With reference to FIGS. 2A to 2B, an embodiment of a method **200** may include, at runtime, managing two or more power states for a circuit block at box **221**, managing a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states at box **222**, setting a watchdog timer in response to the request at box **223**, and monitoring the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state at box **224**. Some embodiments of the method **200** may further include reporting an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires at box **225**. For example, the method **200** may include reporting an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires at box **226**. The method **200** may also include reporting an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires at box **227**. Some embodiments of the method **200** may also include generating an interrupt to an OSPM that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires at box **228**, and/or forcing the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations at box **229** (e.g., or a threshold number of generated interrupts).

(43) Some embodiments of the method **200** may additionally or alternatively include maintaining a timeout counter for the watchdog timer at box **231**, and initializing the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state at box **232**. The method **200** may further include decrementing the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state at box **233**, and generating an interrupt to an OSPM that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value at box **234** (e.g., timeout counter=0).

(44) Any of the circuit blocks described herein including, for example, the processor **804** (FIG. 8), the cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** (FIG. 8), the control hub **832** (FIG. 8), the VR **814** (FIG. 8), the memory interface **834** (FIG. 8), the core **990** (FIG. 9B), the cores **1102A-N** (FIG. 11), the special purpose logic **1108** (FIG. 11), the IMCs **1114** (FIG. 11), the bus controller **1116** (FIG. 11), the

processor **1210** (FIG. 12), the controller hub **1220** (FIG. 12; e.g., and/or the GMCH **1290** and the IOH **1250**), the co-processor **1245** (FIG. 12), the processor **1315** (FIG. 13), the processor **1370** (FIG. 13), the processor/coprocessor **1380** (FIG. 13), the coprocessor **1338** (FIG. 13), the chipset **1390** (FIG. 14), the coprocessor **1520** (FIG. 15), and/or the processors **1614**, **1616** (FIG. 16), may be configured to perform an embodiment of the method **200** at runtime. In particular, embodiments of the method **200** may be performed by a suitably configured PCU **810a,b** (FIG. 8), and/or PMIC **812** (FIG. 8).

(45) With reference to FIG. 3, an embodiment of an apparatus **300** may include two or more circuit blocks (CBs) **315** (e.g., CB-1 through CB-N, where $N > 1$) co-located on a same substrate, and two or more power management circuits **335** (e.g., PMWD circuits PMWD-1 through PMWD-N) respectively coupled to the two or more circuit blocks **315**. As shown in FIG. 3, the PMWD circuits may be integrated with their respective circuit blocks. The two or more power management circuits **335** may be configured to manage two or more power states for a circuit block coupled thereto, to manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, to set a watchdog timer in response to the request, and to monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state. In some embodiments, the two or more power management circuits **335** may be further configured to report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires. For example, the two or more power management circuits **335** may be additionally configured to report an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires. The two or more power management circuits **335** may also be configured to report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(46) In some embodiments, the two or more power management circuits **335** may be further configured to generate an interrupt to an OSPM that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires, and/or to force the circuit block to transition to the requested power state (e.g., after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations or generated interrupts). For example, the circuit block may include internal hardware that is responsive to a failsafe signal from the PMWD to halt the current operation of the circuit block, save the state of the circuit block as needed, and transition to the requested power state. Embodiments of internal failsafe circuitry of the circuit block may force the transition and provide another level of failsafe power state transitions if the requested power state is not reached before the watchdog timer expires.

(47) In some embodiments, the two or more power management circuits **335** may be additionally or alternatively configured to maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, and to initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state. The two or more power management circuits **335** may also be configured to decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and to generate an interrupt to an OSPM that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.

(48) In some embodiments, the apparatus **300** may further include memory in each of the two or more power management circuits **335** to store the configuration information and/or data for the PMWD operation. The memory may be implemented with any suitable storage technology such as a buffer, a set of registers, counters, model specific registers (MSRs), RAM, etc. The configuration information may have any suitable data structure, such as a table of entries for each circuit block. Each entry in the table may include one or more fields that store different values for the circuit block (e.g., either the circuit block itself or an identifier associated with the circuit block) and a value for various factors associated with the circuit block.

(49) Embodiments of the PMWD circuits **335** may be integrated with any of the circuit blocks

described herein including, for example, the processor **804** (FIG. 8), the cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** (FIG. 8), the control hub **832** (FIG. 8), the VR **814** (FIG. 8), the memory interface **834** (FIG. 8), the core **990** (FIG. 9B), the cores **1102A-N** (FIG. 11), the special purpose logic **1108** (FIG. 11), the IMCs **1114** (FIG. 11), the bus controller **1116** (FIG. 11), the processor **1210** (FIG. 12), the controller hub **1220** (FIG. 12; e.g., and/or the GMCH **1290** and the IOH **1250**), the co-processor **1245** (FIG. 12), the processor **1315** (FIG. 13), the processor **1370** (FIG. 13), the processor/coprocessor **1380** (FIG. 13), the coprocessor **1338** (FIG. 13), the chipset **1390** (FIG. 14), the coprocessor **1520** (FIG. 15), and/or the processors **1614**, **1616** (FIG. 16). In particular, embodiments of the PMWD circuits **335** may be incorporated in the PCU **810a,b** (FIG. 8), and/or the PMIC **812** (FIG. 8).

(50) With reference to FIG. 4, an embodiment of a workflow **400** illustrates an interaction between an operating system power management agent (e.g., an OSPM) and a PMWD module/agent, and an example scenario where a watchdog timeout interrupt happens. In this example, two consecutive timeout interrupts are considered to indicate that the HW IP failed to enter the requested low power state, and the OSPM is then to send a notification to the user for appropriate action(s). Example variables/registers maintained by the OSPM and PMWD include “X” to indicate the HW IP name (e.g., which may correspond to a serial port, a display controller, etc.), “Pr” to indicate a power state requested by the OSPM and for the PMWD to monitor on HW IP X, and “N” to indicate a time period that HW IP X should enter the power state Pr requested by the OSPM. For the workflow **400**, the PMWD technology may be located within the HW IP X.

(51) As shown in FIG. 4, the workflow **400** starts at box **411** where, after power-on, the system stays in an idle state or a busy state. At box **412**, the OSPM requests the HW IP X to enter the Pr state, and asks the PMWD to monitor whether the Pr state is reached or not on the HW IP X within the time N. At box **413**, the PMWD monitors whether the Pr state is reached within the time N, continually. If the HW IP X does not enter the Pr state within the time N at box **413**, then an interrupt is raised to the OSPM for the PMWD timeout and the OSPM checks if the interrupt corresponds to a second PMWD timeout interrupt at box **414**. If not, the OSPM returns to box **412** and again requests the HW IP X to enter the Pr state, and again asks the PMWD to monitor whether the Pr state is reached or not on the HW IP X within the time N. If the interrupt at box **414** corresponds to the second PMWD timeout interrupt, then the OSPM sends a warning message to a user interface (UI) at box **415** to indicate that the HW IP X failed to enter the requested Pr state (e.g., and that hardware devices may be wasting energy) and to take further appropriate automatic or manual action. If the circuit block is suitably configured, the workflow **400** may also include forcing the transition to Pr after the second PMWD timeout interrupt at box **415**.

Example of PWMD Technology Inside a Circuit Block

(52) Embodiments of a PMWD may be provided in a circuit block and preferably in each circuit block of a system to monitor whether a power state requested by the OSPM is reached or not within a timeout period. For example, embodiments may check whether a current power state of the circuit block is deeper than a power state requested by the OSPM. If the power state of the circuit block does not reach the requested power state in time, the PMWD will raise an interrupt to the OSPM.

(53) Example registers and/or counters for an embodiment of a PMWD module/unit integrated with a circuit block include: a current power state register “CPS” that contains a current power state of the circuit block (e.g., P0 through Pn, where Pn corresponds to the deepest power state); a register “Px” to save the current power state of the circuit block; a register “Pr” to save the power state requested by the OSPM for the circuit block to enter; a register “N” to save a timeout period requested by the OSPM, where the OSPM expects the circuit block to enter the power state Pr within the period N; and a counter “time_out” to indicate when the watchdog timer times out (e.g., initialized to N as requested by the OSPM thereafter managed as a watchdog countdown timer).

(54) With reference to FIG. 5, an embodiment of a computer system **500** includes an OSPM **521**

and a plurality of circuit blocks **522** (e.g., HW IP 1 through HW IP N) including a circuit block **522x** (HW IP X) coupled to the OSPM. Each of the circuit blocks **522** includes a PMWD circuit integrated therewith, with an expanded view of a PMWD **524** for the circuit block **522x** showing an embodiment of a PMWD flow (e.g., with the above-noted registers and counters). As shown in FIG. 5, the OSPM **521** requests the circuit block **522x** to enter the Pr state (e.g., saving the requested power state in the register Pr) and sends a time period N to the PMWD **524** for the watchdog timeout. The PMWD **524** initializes the time_out counter to be equal to N per the OSPM request. The PMWD **524** then checks whether a current power state Px is deeper than the request power state Pr. For example, the PMWD gets the current power state from a CPS register **526** and sets the register Px to the value of the CPS **526**. The PMWD **524** then checks if the Pr power state is reached by comparing the value of the registers Pr and Px. If Px is greater than or equal to Pr, then the Pr state is reached and the PMWD **524** returns to re-set the time_out counter to N and the power state failsafe monitoring continues.

(55) If $P_x < P_r$, then the PMWD **524** proceeds to decrease the time_out counter. Because the current power state stored in Px is not deeper than Pr (e.g., the Pr state is not reached), the time_out counter counts down towards the watchdog timeout. The PMWD **524** then checks if the time_out counter is equal to zero. If not, then the PMWD **524** returns to re-check the current power state and the power state failsafe monitoring continues. If the time_out counter reaches zero, then the PMWD **524** raises an interrupt to the OSPM **521** to indicate the power state transition failure of the circuit block **522x**.

(56) Embodiments of the PMWD circuit **524** may be integrated with any of the circuit blocks described herein including, for example, the processor **804** (FIG. 8), the cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** (FIG. 8), the control hub **832** (FIG. 8), the VR **814** (FIG. 8), the memory interface **834** (FIG. 8), the core **990** (FIG. 9B), the cores **1102A-N** (FIG. 11), the special purpose logic **1108** (FIG. 11), the IMCs **1114** (FIG. 11), the bus controller **1116** (FIG. 11), the processor **1210** (FIG. 12), the controller hub **1220** (FIG. 12; e.g., and/or the GMCH **1290** and the IOH **1250**), the co-processor **1245** (FIG. 12), the processor **1315** (FIG. 13), the processor **1370** (FIG. 13), the processor/coprocessor **1380** (FIG. 13), the coprocessor **1338** (FIG. 13), the chipset **1390** (FIG. 14), the coprocessor **1520** (FIG. 15), and/or the processors **1614**, **1616** (FIG. 16). In particular, embodiments of the PMWD circuit **524** may be incorporated in the PCU **810a,b** (FIG. 8), and/or the PMIC **812** (FIG. 8).

(57) FIG. 6 shows an embodiment of an SOC **600** that comprises a die with multiple IP blocks therein including the illustrated four cores (Core 0, Core 1, Core 2, and Core 3), a graphics processor unit (GPU), and two memory controllers (MC 1, MC 2). The die of the SOC **600** may be mounted between a package substrate and an integrated heat spreader (IHS). Thermal interface material (TIM) may be provided around the die of the SOC **600** and between the package substrate and the IHS. A plurality of the circuit blocks of the SOC **600** each comprise a PMWD circuit that implements one or more aspects of the embodiments described herein. An SOC with multiple IP blocks (e.g., such as SOC **600**) may have different power states across each IP block.

Advantageously, some embodiments provide circuit block-level granularity for failsafe power state management such that if a particular IP block of the SOC **600** becomes problematic, the PMWD circuit associated with the problematic IP block will monitor for a failed power state transition and identify the problematic IP block to the OSPM.

(58) Although most of the PMWD circuits are illustrated in FIG. 6 as being co-located with their respective IP blocks, in some embodiments one or more of the PMWD circuits may be physically separated from their respective IP blocks and located elsewhere at a suitable location in the SOC **600** (e.g., in a controller such as a PCU). For example, a separate PMWD circuit **631** may be coupled to the GPU block. Alternatively, in some embodiments one or more of the PMWD circuits may be incorporated in another controller that is coupled to the SOC (e.g., an external PMIC, a PCU, etc.).

(59) With reference to FIG. 7, an embodiment of a system **700** includes hardware **710** and software **750**. The hardware **710** includes CPU and memory components **712**, multiple cores including big cores **714** and small cores **716**, various security and controller components **720** (e.g., such as INTEL Converged Security and Management Engine (CSME), a trusted execution environment (TEE), a baseboard management controller (BMC), etc.), and other IP block(s) **730**, some of which incorporate a PMWD circuit that includes one or more aspects of the embodiments described herein. The software **750** includes various unified extensible firmware interface (UEFI) components including a UEFI OS **752**, pre-boot tools **754**, and UEFI platform initialization components (e.g., platform drivers **756**, silicon component modules **758**). A full system stack between the hardware **710** and a user may include firmware, an OS, a network interface, drivers, libraries, applications, and a graphical user interface. In accordance with some embodiments, the hardware **710** provides platform telemetry (e.g., power state information to be used by PMWD circuits), the OS and the firmware provide power management watchdog exposure and resource reservation, and the OS includes an OSPM that includes a power management watchdog mode.

(60) FIG. 8 illustrates a computer system or computing device **800** (also referred to as device **800**), where PMWD technology in two or more circuit blocks of the device **800**, in accordance with some embodiments, generates interrupts to an OSPM of the device **800** based on failsafe power state management for the two or more circuit blocks of the device **800**.

(61) In some embodiments, device **800** represents an appropriate computing device, such as a computing tablet, a mobile phone or smart-phone, a laptop, a desktop, an Internet-of-Things (IOT) device, a server, a wearable device, a set-top box, a wireless-enabled e-reader, or the like. It will be understood that certain components are shown generally, and not all components of such a device are shown in device **800**.

(62) In an example, the device **800** comprises a SOC **801**. An example boundary of the SOC **801** is illustrated using dotted lines in FIG. 8, with some example components being illustrated to be included within SOC **801**. However, SOC **801** may include any appropriate components of device **800**.

(63) In some embodiments, device **800** includes processor **804**. Processor **804** can include one or more physical devices, such as microprocessors, application processors, microcontrollers, programmable logic devices, processing cores, or other processing means. The processing operations performed by processor **804** include the execution of an operating platform or OS on which applications and/or device functions are executed. The processing operations include operations related to I/O (input/output) with a human user or with other devices, operations related to power management, operations related to connecting computing device **800** to another device, and/or the like. The processing operations may also include operations related to audio I/O and/or display I/O.

(64) In some embodiments, processor **804** includes multiple processing cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** (also referred to individually or collectively as core(s) **808**). Although merely three cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** are illustrated in FIG. 8, the processor **804** may include any other appropriate number of processing cores, e.g., tens, or even hundreds of processing cores. Processor cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c** may be implemented on a single integrated circuit (IC) chip. Moreover, the chip may include one or more shared and/or private caches, buses or interconnections, graphics and/or memory controllers, or other components.

(65) In some embodiments, processor **804** includes cache **806**. In an example, sections of cache **806** may be dedicated to individual cores **808** (e.g., a first section of cache **806** dedicated to core **808a**, a second section of cache **806** dedicated to core **808b**, and so on). In an example, one or more sections of cache **806** may be shared among two or more of cores **808**. Cache **806** may be split in different levels, e.g., level 1 (L1) cache, level 2 (L2) cache, level 3 (L3) cache, etc.

(66) In some embodiments, a core **808** of the processor **804** may include a fetch unit to fetch instructions (including instructions with conditional branches) for execution by the core **808**. The

instructions may be fetched from any storage devices such as the memory **830**. Core **808** may also include a decode unit to decode the fetched instruction. For example, the decode unit may decode the fetched instruction into a plurality of micro-operations. Core **808** may include a schedule unit to perform various operations associated with storing decoded instructions. For example, the schedule unit may hold data from the decode unit until the instructions are ready for dispatch, e.g., until all source values of a decoded instruction become available. In one embodiment, the schedule unit may schedule and/or issue (or dispatch) decoded instructions to an execution unit for execution.

(67) The execution unit may execute the dispatched instructions after they are decoded (e.g., by the decode unit) and dispatched (e.g., by the schedule unit). In an embodiment, the execution unit may include more than one execution unit (such as an imaging computational unit, a graphics computational unit, a general-purpose computational unit, etc.). The execution unit may also perform various arithmetic operations such as addition, subtraction, multiplication, and/or division, and may include one or more arithmetic logic units (ALUs). In an embodiment, a co-processor (not shown) may perform various arithmetic operations in conjunction with the execution unit.

(68) Further, execution unit may execute instructions out-of-order. Hence, core **808** may be an out-of-order processor core in one embodiment. Core **808** may also include a retirement unit. The retirement unit may retire executed instructions after they are committed. In an embodiment, retirement of the executed instructions may result in processor state being committed from the execution of the instructions, physical registers used by the instructions being de-allocated, etc. The processor **804** may also include a bus unit to enable communication between components of the processor **804** and other components via one or more buses. Processor **804** may also include one or more registers to store data accessed by various components of the cores **808** (such as values related to assigned app priorities and/or sub-system states (modes) association).

(69) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises connectivity circuitries **831**. For example, connectivity circuitries **831** includes hardware devices (e.g., wireless and/or wired connectors and communication hardware) and/or software components (e.g., drivers, protocol stacks), e.g., to enable device **800** to communicate with external devices. Device **800** may be separate from the external devices, such as other computing devices, wireless access points or base stations, etc.

(70) In an example, connectivity circuitries **831** may include multiple different types of connectivity. To generalize, the connectivity circuitries **831** may include cellular connectivity circuitries, wireless connectivity circuitries, etc. Cellular connectivity circuitries of connectivity circuitries **831** refers generally to cellular network connectivity provided by wireless carriers, such as provided via GSM (global system for mobile communications) or variations or derivatives, CDMA (code division multiple access) or variations or derivatives, TDM (time division multiplexing) or variations or derivatives, 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) Universal Mobile Telecommunications Systems (UMTS) system or variations or derivatives, 3GPP Long-Term Evolution (LTE) system or variations or derivatives, 3GPP LTE-Advanced (LTE-A) system or variations or derivatives, Fifth Generation (5G) wireless system or variations or derivatives, 5G mobile networks system or variations or derivatives, 5G New Radio (NR) system or variations or derivatives, or other cellular service standards. Wireless connectivity circuitries (or wireless interface) of the connectivity circuitries **831** refers to wireless connectivity that is not cellular, and can include personal area networks (such as Bluetooth, Near Field, etc.), local area networks (such as Wi-Fi), and/or wide area networks (such as WiMax), and/or other wireless communication. In an example, connectivity circuitries **831** may include a network interface, such as a wired or wireless interface, e.g., so that a system embodiment may be incorporated into a wireless device, for example, cell phone or personal digital assistant.

(71) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises control hub **832**, which represents hardware devices and/or software components related to interaction with one or more I/O devices. For example, processor **804** may communicate with one or more of display **822**, one or more peripheral devices **824**, storage devices **828**, one or more other external devices **829**, etc., via control hub **832**.

Control hub **832** may be a chipset, a Platform Control Hub (PCH), and/or the like.

(72) For example, control hub **832** illustrates one or more connection points for additional devices that connect to device **800**, e.g., through which a user might interact with the system. For example, devices (e.g., devices **829**) that can be attached to device **800** include microphone devices, speaker or stereo systems, audio devices, video systems or other display devices, keyboard or keypad devices, or other I/O devices for use with specific applications such as card readers or other devices.

(73) As mentioned above, control hub **832** can interact with audio devices, display **822**, etc. For example, input through a microphone or other audio device can provide input or commands for one or more applications or functions of device **800**. Additionally, audio output can be provided instead of, or in addition to display output. In another example, if display **822** includes a touch screen, display **822** also acts as an input device, which can be at least partially managed by control hub **832**. There can also be additional buttons or switches on computing device **800** to provide I/O functions managed by control hub **832**. In one embodiment, control hub **832** manages devices such as accelerometers, cameras, light sensors or other environmental sensors, or other hardware that can be included in device **800**. The input can be part of direct user interaction, as well as providing environmental input to the system to influence its operations (such as filtering for noise, adjusting displays for brightness detection, applying a flash for a camera, or other features).

(74) In some embodiments, control hub **832** may couple to various devices using any appropriate communication protocol, e.g., PCIe (Peripheral Component Interconnect Express), USB (Universal Serial Bus), Thunderbolt, High Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI), Firewire, etc.

(75) In some embodiments, display **822** represents hardware (e.g., display devices) and software (e.g., drivers) components that provide a visual and/or tactile display for a user to interact with device **800**. Display **822** may include a display interface, a display screen, and/or hardware device used to provide a display to a user. In some embodiments, display **822** includes a touch screen (or touch pad) device that provides both output and input to a user. In an example, display **822** may communicate directly with the processor **804**. Display **822** can be one or more of an internal display device, as in a mobile electronic device or a laptop device or an external display device attached via a display interface (e.g., DisplayPort, etc.). In one embodiment display **822** can be a head mounted display (HMD) such as a stereoscopic display device for use in virtual reality (VR) applications or augmented reality (AR) applications.

(76) In some embodiments and although not illustrated in the figure, in addition to (or instead of) processor **804**, device **800** may include Graphics Processing Unit (GPU) comprising one or more graphics processing cores, which may control one or more aspects of displaying contents on display **822**.

(77) Control hub **832** (or platform controller hub) may include hardware interfaces and connectors, as well as software components (e.g., drivers, protocol stacks) to make peripheral connections, e.g., to peripheral devices **824**.

(78) It will be understood that device **800** could both be a peripheral device to other computing devices, as well as have peripheral devices connected to it. Device **800** may have a “docking” connector to connect to other computing devices for purposes such as managing (e.g., downloading and/or uploading, changing, synchronizing) content on device **800**. Additionally, a docking connector can allow device **800** to connect to certain peripherals that allow computing device **800** to control content output, for example, to audiovisual or other systems.

(79) In addition to a proprietary docking connector or other proprietary connection hardware, device **800** can make peripheral connections via common or standards-based connectors. Common types can include a Universal Serial Bus (USB) connector (which can include any of a number of different hardware interfaces), DisplayPort including MiniDisplayPort (MDP), High Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI), Firewire, or other types.

(80) In some embodiments, connectivity circuitries **831** may be coupled to control hub **832**, e.g., in

addition to, or instead of, being coupled directly to the processor **804**. In some embodiments, display **822** may be coupled to control hub **832**, e.g., in addition to, or instead of, being coupled directly to processor **804**.

(81) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises memory **830** coupled to processor **804** via memory interface **834**. Memory **830** includes memory devices for storing information in device **800**. Memory can include nonvolatile (state does not change if power to the memory device is interrupted) and/or volatile (state is indeterminate if power to the memory device is interrupted) memory devices. Memory **830** can be a dynamic random access memory (DRAM) device, a static random access memory (SRAM) device, flash memory device, phase-change memory device, or some other memory device having suitable performance to serve as process memory. In one embodiment, memory **830** can operate as system memory for device **800**, to store data and instructions for use when the one or more processors **804** executes an application or process. Memory **830** can store application data, user data, music, photos, documents, or other data, as well as system data (whether long-term or temporary) related to the execution of the applications and functions of device **800**.

(82) Elements of various embodiments and examples are also provided as a machine-readable medium (e.g., memory **830**) for storing the computer-executable instructions (e.g., instructions to implement any other processes discussed herein). The machine-readable medium (e.g., memory **830**) may include, but is not limited to, flash memory, optical disks, CD-ROMs, DVD ROMs, RAMs, EPROMs, EEPROMs, magnetic or optical cards, phase change memory (PCM), or other types of machine-readable media suitable for storing electronic or computer-executable instructions. For example, embodiments of the disclosure may be downloaded as a computer program (e.g., BIOS) which may be transferred from a remote computer (e.g., a server) to a requesting computer (e.g., a client) by way of data signals via a communication link (e.g., a modem or network connection).

(83) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises temperature measurement circuitries **840**, e.g., for measuring temperature of various components of device **800**. In an example, temperature measurement circuitries **840** may be embedded, or coupled or attached to various components, whose temperature are to be measured and monitored. For example, temperature measurement circuitries **840** may measure temperature of (or within) one or more of cores **808a**, **808b**, **808c**, voltage regulator **814**, memory **830**, a mother-board of SOC **801**, and/or any appropriate component of device **800**.

(84) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises power measurement circuitries **842**, e.g., for measuring power consumed by one or more components of the device **800**. In an example, in addition to, or instead of, measuring power, the power measurement circuitries **842** may measure voltage and/or current. In an example, the power measurement circuitries **842** may be embedded, or coupled or attached to various components, whose power, voltage, and/or current consumption are to be measured and monitored. For example, power measurement circuitries **842** may measure power, current and/or voltage supplied by one or more voltage regulators **814**, power supplied to SOC **801**, power supplied to device **800**, power consumed by processor **804** (or any other component) of device **800**, etc.

(85) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises one or more voltage regulator circuitries, generally referred to as voltage regulator (VR) **814**. VR **814** generates signals at appropriate voltage levels, which may be supplied to operate any appropriate components of the device **800**. Merely as an example, VR **814** is illustrated to be supplying signals to processor **804** of device **800**. In some embodiments, VR **814** receives one or more Voltage Identification (VID) signals, and generates the voltage signal at an appropriate level, based on the VID signals. Various type of VRs may be utilized for the VR **814**. For example, VR **814** may include a “buck” VR, “boost” VR, a combination of buck and boost VRs, low dropout (LDO) regulators, switching DC-DC regulators, etc. Buck VR is generally used in power delivery applications in which an input voltage needs to be

transformed to an output voltage in a ratio that is smaller than unity. Boost VR is generally used in power delivery applications in which an input voltage needs to be transformed to an output voltage in a ratio that is larger than unity. In some embodiments, each processor core has its own VR which is controlled by PCU **810a/b** and/or PMIC **812**. In some embodiments, each core has a network of distributed LDOs to provide efficient control for power management. The LDOs can be digital, analog, or a combination of digital or analog LDOs.

(86) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises one or more clock generator circuitries, generally referred to as clock generator **816**. Clock generator **816** generates clock signals at appropriate frequency levels, which may be supplied to any appropriate components of device **800**. Merely as an example, clock generator **816** is illustrated to be supplying clock signals to processor **804** of device **800**. In some embodiments, clock generator **816** receives one or more Frequency Identification (FID) signals, and generates the clock signals at an appropriate frequency, based on the FID signals.

(87) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises battery **818** supplying power to various components of device **800**. Merely as an example, battery **818** is illustrated to be supplying power to processor **804**. Although not illustrated in the figures, device **800** may comprise a charging circuitry, e.g., to recharge the battery, based on Alternating Current (AC) power supply received from an AC adapter.

(88) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises Power Control Unit (PCU) **810** (also referred to as Power Management Unit (PMU), Power Controller, etc.). In an example, some sections of PCU **810** may be implemented by one or more processing cores **808**, and these sections of PCU **810** are symbolically illustrated using a dotted box and labelled PCU **810a**. In an example, some other sections of PCU **810** may be implemented outside the processing cores **808**, and these sections of PCU **810** are symbolically illustrated using a dotted box and labelled as PCU **810b**. PCU **810** may implement various power management operations for device **800**. PCU **810** may include hardware interfaces, hardware circuitries, connectors, registers, etc., as well as software components (e.g., drivers, protocol stacks), to implement various power management operations for device **800**.

(89) In some embodiments, device **800** comprises Power Management Integrated Circuit (PMIC) **812**, e.g., to implement various power management operations for device **800**. In some embodiments, PMIC **812** is a Reconfigurable Power Management ICs (RPMICs) and/or an IMVP (Intel® Mobile Voltage Positioning). In an example, the PMIC is within an IC chip separate from processor **804**. The may implement various power management operations for device **800**. PMIC **812** may include hardware interfaces, hardware circuitries, connectors, registers, etc., as well as software components (e.g., drivers, protocol stacks), to implement various power management operations for device **800**.

(90) In an example, device **800** comprises one or both PCU **810** or PMIC **812**. In an example, any one of PCU **810** or PMIC **812** may be absent in device **800**, and hence, these components are illustrated using dotted lines.

(91) Various power management operations of device **800** may be performed by PCU **810**, by PMIC **812**, or by a combination of PCU **810** and PMIC **812**. For example, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** may select a power state (e.g., P-state) for various components of device **800**. For example, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** may select a power state (e.g., in accordance with the ACPI (Advanced Configuration and Power Interface) specification) for various components of device **800**. Merely as an example, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** may cause various components of the device **800** to transition to a sleep state, to an active state, to an appropriate C state (e.g., C0 state, or another appropriate C state, in accordance with the ACPI specification), etc. In an example, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** may control a voltage output by VR **814** and/or a frequency of a clock signal output by the clock generator, e.g., by outputting the VID signal and/or the FID signal, respectively. In an example, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** may control battery power usage, charging of battery **818**, and features related to power saving operation. In accordance with some embodiments,

PMWD technology may utilize a watchdog timer for various components of the device **800** to monitor a transition between power states of the various components (e.g., particularly from higher power states to lower power states) and provide a failsafe that generates an interrupt to an OSPM if the transition fails (e.g., if the watchdog timer expires).

(92) The clock generator **816** can comprise a phase locked loop (PLL), frequency locked loop (FLL), or any suitable clock source. In some embodiments, each core of processor **804** has its own clock source. As such, each core can operate at a frequency independent of the frequency of operation of the other core. In some embodiments, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** performs adaptive or dynamic frequency scaling or adjustment. For example, clock frequency of a processor core can be increased if the core is not operating at its maximum power consumption threshold or limit. In some embodiments, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** determines the operating condition of each core of a processor, and opportunistically adjusts frequency and/or power supply voltage of that core without the core clocking source (e.g., PLL of that core) losing lock when the PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** determines that the core is operating below a target performance level. For example, if a core is drawing current from a power supply rail less than a total current allocated for that core or processor **804**, then PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** can temporarily increase the power draw for that core or processor **804** (e.g., by increasing clock frequency and/or power supply voltage level) so that the core or processor **804** can perform at higher performance level. As such, voltage and/or frequency can be increased temporarily for processor **804** without violating product reliability.

(93) In an example, PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** may perform power management operations, e.g., based at least in part on receiving measurements from power measurement circuitries **842**, temperature measurement circuitries **840**, charge level of battery **818**, and/or any other appropriate information that may be used for power management. To that end, PMIC **812** is communicatively coupled to one or more sensors to sense/detect various values/variations in one or more factors having an effect on power/thermal behavior of the system/platform. Examples of the one or more factors include electrical current, voltage droop, temperature, operating frequency, operating voltage, power consumption, inter-core communication activity, etc. One or more of these sensors may be provided in physical proximity (and/or thermal contact/coupling) with one or more components or logic/IP blocks of a computing system. Additionally, sensor(s) may be directly coupled to PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** in at least one embodiment to allow PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812** to manage processor core energy at least in part based on value(s) detected by one or more of the sensors.

(94) Also illustrated is an example software stack of device **800** (although not all elements of the software stack are illustrated). Merely as an example, processors **804** may execute application programs **850**, OS **852**, one or more Power Management (PM) specific application programs (e.g., generically referred to as PM applications **858**), and/or the like. PM applications **858** may also be executed by the PCU **810** and/or PMIC **812**. OS **852** may also include one or more PM applications **856a**, **856b**, **856c** (e.g., including an OSPM). The OS **852** may also include various drivers **854a**, **854b**, **854c**, etc., some of which may be specific for power management purposes. In some embodiments, device **800** may further comprise a Basic Input/Output System (BIOS) **820**. BIOS **820** may communicate with OS **852** (e.g., via one or more drivers **854**), communicate with processors **804**, etc.

(95) For example, one or more of PM applications **858**, **856**, drivers **854**, BIOS **820**, etc. may be used to implement power management specific tasks, e.g., to control voltage and/or frequency of various components of device **800**, to control wake-up state, sleep state, and/or any other appropriate power state of various components of device **800**, control battery power usage, charging of the battery **818**, features related to power saving operation, etc.

(96) In some embodiments, multiple tasks are variously performed each with a respective one of application programs **850** and/or OS **852**. At a given time during operation of computing device **800**, at least some of the tasks each result in, or otherwise correspond to, a respective input being

received via one or more human interface devices (HIDs). Said tasks each further include or otherwise correspond to a different respective data flow by which computing device **800** communicates with one or more networks (e.g., via connectivity circuitries **831**). User input and/or other characteristics of user behavior are detected with the one or more HIDs, and provide a basis for detecting a relative interest by the user in one task over one or more other copending tasks. By way of illustration and not limitation, OS **852** provides a kernel space in which QoS logic, a filter driver, and/or other suitable software logic executes to detect a task which is currently of relatively greater user interest, and to prioritize a data flow which corresponds to said task. An indication of the relative prioritization of tasks (e.g., and the relative prioritization of corresponding data flows) is communicated, for example, from processor **804** to connectivity circuitries **831**. Based on such signaling, connectivity circuitries **831** variously processes data packets according to the prioritization of tasks relative to each other.

(97) In accordance with some embodiments, the PMIC **812** and/or a PCU (e.g., such as PCU **810a** inside the core **808a**, or such as the PCU **810b** outside the processor **804**) is further configured with PMWD technology as described herein to generate interrupts to an OSPM of the OS **852** based on monitoring of the blocks of the SOC **801** (e.g., the cores **808**, the cache **806**, the VR(s) **814**, the memory interface **834**, etc.). In some embodiments, power state data may be provided to the suitably configured PCU/PMIC, the PCU/PMIC monitors the watchdog timers and the transition from current power states to requested power states, and the PCU/PMIC generates interrupts to the OSPM as needed (e.g., together with information that identifies the block that failed to transition, and optionally also the current power state of the block and the requested power state).

(98) Those skilled in the art will appreciate that a wide variety of devices may benefit from the foregoing embodiments. The following exemplary core architectures, processors, and computer architectures are non-limiting examples of devices that may beneficially incorporate embodiments of the technology described herein.

Exemplary Core Architectures, Processors, and Computer Architectures

(99) Processor cores may be implemented in different ways, for different purposes, and in different processors. For instance, implementations of such cores may include: 1) a general purpose in-order core intended for general-purpose computing; 2) a high performance general purpose out-of-order core intended for general-purpose computing; 3) a special purpose core intended primarily for graphics and/or scientific (throughput) computing. Implementations of different processors may include: 1) a CPU including one or more general purpose in-order cores intended for general-purpose computing and/or one or more general purpose out-of-order cores intended for general-purpose computing; and 2) a coprocessor including one or more special purpose cores intended primarily for graphics and/or scientific (throughput). Such different processors lead to different computer system architectures, which may include: 1) the coprocessor on a separate chip from the CPU; 2) the coprocessor on a separate die in the same package as a CPU; 3) the coprocessor on the same die as a CPU (in which case, such a coprocessor is sometimes referred to as special purpose logic, such as integrated graphics and/or scientific (throughput) logic, or as special purpose cores); and 4) a system on a chip that may include on the same die the described CPU (sometimes referred to as the application core(s) or application processor(s)), the above described coprocessor, and additional functionality. Exemplary core architectures are described next, followed by descriptions of exemplary processors and computer architectures.

Exemplary Core Architectures

In-Order and Out-of-Order Core Block Diagram

(100) FIG. **9A** is a block diagram illustrating both an exemplary in-order pipeline and an exemplary register renaming, out-of-order issue/execution pipeline according to embodiments of the invention. FIG. **9B** is a block diagram illustrating both an exemplary embodiment of an in-order architecture core and an exemplary register renaming, out-of-order issue/execution architecture core to be included in a processor according to embodiments of the invention. The solid lined

boxes in FIGS. 9A-B illustrate the in-order pipeline and in-order core, while the optional addition of the dashed lined boxes illustrates the register renaming, out-of-order issue/execution pipeline and core. Given that the in-order aspect is a subset of the out-of-order aspect, the out-of-order aspect will be described.

(101) In FIG. 9A, a processor pipeline **900** includes a fetch stage **902**, a length decode stage **904**, a decode stage **906**, an allocation stage **908**, a renaming stage **910**, a scheduling (also known as a dispatch or issue) stage **912**, a register read/memory read stage **914**, an execute stage **916**, a write back/memory write stage **918**, an exception handling stage **922**, and a commit stage **924**.

(102) FIG. 9B shows processor core **990** including a front end unit **930** coupled to an execution engine unit **950**, and both are coupled to a memory unit **970**. The core **990** may be a reduced instruction set computing (RISC) core, a complex instruction set computing (CISC) core, a very long instruction word (VLIW) core, or a hybrid or alternative core type. As yet another option, the core **990** may be a special-purpose core, such as, for example, a network or communication core, compression engine, coprocessor core, general purpose computing graphics processing unit (GPGPU) core, graphics core, or the like.

(103) The front end unit **930** includes a branch prediction unit **932** coupled to an instruction cache unit **934**, which is coupled to an instruction translation lookaside buffer (TLB) **936**, which is coupled to an instruction fetch unit **938**, which is coupled to a decode unit **940**. The decode unit **940** (or decoder) may decode instructions, and generate as an output one or more micro-operations, micro-code entry points, microinstructions, other instructions, or other control signals, which are decoded from, or which otherwise reflect, or are derived from, the original instructions. The decode unit **940** may be implemented using various different mechanisms. Examples of suitable mechanisms include, but are not limited to, look-up tables, hardware implementations, programmable logic arrays (PLAs), microcode read only memories (ROMs), etc. In one embodiment, the core **990** includes a microcode ROM or other medium that stores microcode for certain macroinstructions (e.g., in decode unit **940** or otherwise within the front end unit **930**). The decode unit **940** is coupled to a rename/allocator unit **952** in the execution engine unit **950**.

(104) The execution engine unit **950** includes the rename/allocator unit **952** coupled to a retirement unit **954** and a set of one or more scheduler unit(s) **956**. The scheduler unit(s) **956** represents any number of different schedulers, including reservations stations, central instruction window, etc. The scheduler unit(s) **956** is coupled to the physical register file(s) unit(s) **958**. Each of the physical register file(s) units **958** represents one or more physical register files, different ones of which store one or more different data types, such as scalar integer, scalar floating point, packed integer, packed floating point, vector integer, vector floating point, status (e.g., an instruction pointer that is the address of the next instruction to be executed), etc. In one embodiment, the physical register file(s) unit **958** comprises a vector registers unit, a write mask registers unit, and a scalar registers unit. These register units may provide architectural vector registers, vector mask registers, and general purpose registers. The physical register file(s) unit(s) **958** is overlapped by the retirement unit **954** to illustrate various ways in which register renaming and out-of-order execution may be implemented (e.g., using a reorder buffer(s) and a retirement register file(s); using a future file(s), a history buffer(s), and a retirement register file(s); using a register maps and a pool of registers; etc.). The retirement unit **954** and the physical register file(s) unit(s) **958** are coupled to the execution cluster(s) **960**. The execution cluster(s) **960** includes a set of one or more execution units **962** and a set of one or more memory access units **964**. The execution units **962** may perform various operations (e.g., shifts, addition, subtraction, multiplication) and on various types of data (e.g., scalar floating point, packed integer, packed floating point, vector integer, vector floating point). While some embodiments may include a number of execution units dedicated to specific functions or sets of functions, other embodiments may include only one execution unit or multiple execution units that all perform all functions. The scheduler unit(s) **956**, physical register file(s) unit(s) **958**, and execution cluster(s) **960** are shown as being possibly plural because certain

embodiments create separate pipelines for certain types of data/operations (e.g., a scalar integer pipeline, a scalar floating point/packed integer/packed floating point/vector integer/vector floating point pipeline, and/or a memory access pipeline that each have their own scheduler unit, physical register file(s) unit, and/or execution cluster—and in the case of a separate memory access pipeline, certain embodiments are implemented in which only the execution cluster of this pipeline has the memory access unit(s) **964**). It should also be understood that where separate pipelines are used, one or more of these pipelines may be out-of-order issue/execution and the rest in-order.

(105) The set of memory access units **964** is coupled to the memory unit **970**, which includes a data TLB unit **972** coupled to a data cache unit **974** coupled to a level 2 (L2) cache unit **976**. In one exemplary embodiment, the memory access units **964** may include a load unit, a store address unit, and a store data unit, each of which is coupled to the data TLB unit **972** in the memory unit **970**. The instruction cache unit **934** is further coupled to a level 2 (L2) cache unit **976** in the memory unit **970**. The L2 cache unit **976** is coupled to one or more other levels of cache and eventually to a main memory.

(106) By way of example, the exemplary register renaming, out-of-order issue/execution core architecture may implement the pipeline **900** as follows: 1) the instruction fetch unit **938** performs the fetch and length decoding stages **902** and **904**; 2) the decode unit **940** performs the decode stage **906**; 3) the rename/allocator unit **952** performs the allocation stage **908** and renaming stage **910**; 4) the scheduler unit(s) **956** performs the schedule stage **912**; 5) the physical register file(s) unit(s) **958** and the memory unit **970** perform the register read/memory read stage **914**; the execution cluster **960** perform the execute stage **916**; 6) the memory unit **970** and the physical register file(s) unit(s) **958** perform the write back/memory write stage **918**; 7) various units may be involved in the exception handling stage **922**; and 8) the retirement unit **954** and the physical register file(s) unit(s) **958** perform the commit stage **924**.

(107) The core **990** may support one or more instructions sets (e.g., the x86 instruction set (with some extensions that have been added with newer versions); the MIPS instruction set of MIPS Technologies of Sunnyvale, CA; the ARM instruction set (with optional additional extensions such as NEON) of ARM Holdings of Sunnyvale, CA), including the instruction(s) described herein. In one embodiment, the core **990** includes logic to support a packed data instruction set extension (e.g., AVX1, AVX2), thereby allowing the operations used by many multimedia applications to be performed using packed data.

(108) It should be understood that the core may support multithreading (executing two or more parallel sets of operations or threads), and may do so in a variety of ways including time sliced multithreading, simultaneous multithreading (where a single physical core provides a logical core for each of the threads that physical core is simultaneously multithreading), or a combination thereof (e.g., time sliced fetching and decoding and simultaneous multithreading thereafter such as in the Intel® Hyperthreading technology).

(109) While register renaming is described in the context of out-of-order execution, it should be understood that register renaming may be used in an in-order architecture. While the illustrated embodiment of the processor also includes separate instruction and data cache units **934/974** and a shared L2 cache unit **976**, alternative embodiments may have a single internal cache for both instructions and data, such as, for example, a Level 1 (L1) internal cache, or multiple levels of internal cache. In some embodiments, the system may include a combination of an internal cache and an external cache that is external to the core and/or the processor. Alternatively, all of the cache may be external to the core and/or the processor.

Specific Exemplary In-Order Core Architecture

(110) FIGS. **10A-B** illustrate a block diagram of a more specific exemplary in-order core architecture, which core would be one of several logic blocks (including other cores of the same type and/or different types) in a chip. The logic blocks communicate through a high-bandwidth interconnect network (e.g., a ring network) with some fixed function logic, memory I/O interfaces,

and other necessary I/O logic, depending on the application.

(111) FIG. **10A** is a block diagram of a single processor core, along with its connection to the on-die interconnect network **1002** and with its local subset of the Level 2 (L2) cache **1004**, according to embodiments of the invention. In one embodiment, an instruction decoder **1000** supports the x86 instruction set with a packed data instruction set extension. An L1 cache **1006** allows low-latency accesses to cache memory into the scalar and vector units. While in one embodiment (to simplify the design), a scalar unit **1008** and a vector unit **1010** use separate register sets (respectively, scalar registers **1012** and vector registers **1014**) and data transferred between them is written to memory and then read back in from a level 1 (L1) cache **1006**, alternative embodiments of the invention may use a different approach (e.g., use a single register set or include a communication path that allow data to be transferred between the two register files without being written and read back).

(112) The local subset of the L2 cache **1004** is part of a global L2 cache that is divided into separate local subsets, one per processor core. Each processor core has a direct access path to its own local subset of the L2 cache **1004**. Data read by a processor core is stored in its L2 cache subset **1004** and can be accessed quickly, in parallel with other processor cores accessing their own local L2 cache subsets. Data written by a processor core is stored in its own L2 cache subset **1004** and is flushed from other subsets, if necessary. The ring network ensures coherency for shared data. The ring network is bi-directional to allow agents such as processor cores, L2 caches and other logic blocks to communicate with each other within the chip. Each ring data-path is 1012-bits wide per direction.

(113) FIG. **10B** is an expanded view of part of the processor core in FIG. **10A** according to embodiments of the invention. FIG. **10B** includes an L1 data cache **1006A** part of the L1 cache **1006**, as well as more detail regarding the vector unit **1010** and the vector registers **1014**. Specifically, the vector unit **1010** is a 16-wide vector processing unit (VPU) (see the 16-wide ALU **1028**), which executes one or more of integer, single-precision float, and double-precision float instructions. The VPU supports swizzling the register inputs with swizzle unit **1020**, numeric conversion with numeric convert units **1022A-B**, and replication with replication unit **1024** on the memory input. Write mask registers **1026** allow predicating resulting vector writes.

(114) FIG. **11** is a block diagram of a processor **1100** that may have more than one core, may have an integrated memory controller, and may have integrated graphics according to embodiments of the invention. The solid lined boxes in FIG. **11** illustrate a processor **1100** with a single core **1102A**, a system agent **1110**, a set of one or more bus controller units **1116**, while the optional addition of the dashed lined boxes illustrates an alternative processor **1100** with multiple cores **1102A-N**, a set of one or more integrated memory controller unit(s) **1114** in the system agent unit **1110**, and special purpose logic **1108**.

(115) Thus, different implementations of the processor **1100** may include: 1) a CPU with the special purpose logic **1108** being integrated graphics and/or scientific (throughput) logic (which may include one or more cores), and the cores **1102A-N** being one or more general purpose cores (e.g., general purpose in-order cores, general purpose out-of-order cores, a combination of the two); 2) a coprocessor with the cores **1102A-N** being a large number of special purpose cores intended primarily for graphics and/or scientific (throughput); and 3) a coprocessor with the cores **1102A-N** being a large number of general purpose in-order cores. Thus, the processor **1100** may be a general-purpose processor, coprocessor or special-purpose processor, such as, for example, a network or communication processor, compression engine, graphics processor, GPGPU (general purpose graphics processing unit), a high-throughput many integrated core (MIC) coprocessor (including 30 or more cores), embedded processor, or the like. The processor may be implemented on one or more chips. The processor **1100** may be a part of and/or may be implemented on one or more substrates using any of a number of process technologies, such as, for example, BiCMOS, CMOS, or NMOS.

(116) The memory hierarchy includes one or more levels of respective caches **1104A-N** within the

cores **1102A-N**, a set of one or more shared cache units **1106**, and external memory (not shown) coupled to the set of integrated memory controller units **1114**. The set of shared cache units **1106** may include one or more mid-level caches, such as level 2 (L2), level 3 (L3), level 4 (L4), or other levels of cache, a last level cache (LLC), and/or combinations thereof. While in one embodiment a ring based interconnect unit **1112** interconnects the integrated graphics logic **1108**, the set of shared cache units **1106**, and the system agent unit **1110**/integrated memory controller unit(s) **1114**, alternative embodiments may use any number of well-known techniques for interconnecting such units. In one embodiment, coherency is maintained between one or more cache units **1106** and cores **1102A-N**.

(117) In some embodiments, one or more of the cores **1102A-N** are capable of multi-threading. The system agent **1110** includes those components coordinating and operating cores **1102A-N**. The system agent unit **1110** may include for example a power control unit (PCU) and a display unit. The PCU may be or include logic and components needed for regulating the power state of the cores **1102A-N** and the integrated graphics logic **1108**. The display unit is for driving one or more externally connected displays.

(118) The cores **1102A-N** may be homogenous or heterogeneous in terms of architecture instruction set; that is, two or more of the cores **1102A-N** may be capable of execution the same instruction set, while others may be capable of executing only a subset of that instruction set or a different instruction set.

Exemplary Computer Architectures

(119) FIGS. **12-15** are block diagrams of exemplary computer architectures. Other system designs and configurations known in the arts for laptops, desktops, handheld PCs, personal digital assistants, engineering workstations, servers, network devices, network hubs, switches, embedded processors, digital signal processors (DSPs), graphics devices, video game devices, set-top boxes, micro controllers, cell phones, portable media players, hand held devices, and various other electronic devices, are also suitable. In general, a huge variety of systems or electronic devices capable of incorporating a processor and/or other execution logic as disclosed herein are generally suitable.

(120) Referring now to FIG. **12**, shown is a block diagram of a system **1200** in accordance with one embodiment of the present invention. The system **1200** may include one or more processors **1210**, **1215**, which are coupled to a controller hub **1220**. In one embodiment the controller hub **1220** includes a graphics memory controller hub (GMCH) **1290** and an Input/Output Hub (IOH) **1250** (which may be on separate chips); the GMCH **1290** includes memory and graphics controllers to which are coupled memory **1240** and a coprocessor **1245**; the IOH **1250** couples input/output (I/O) devices **1260** to the GMCH **1290**. Alternatively, one or both of the memory and graphics controllers are integrated within the processor (as described herein), the memory **1240** and the coprocessor **1245** are coupled directly to the processor **1210**, and the controller hub **1220** in a single chip with the IOH **1250**.

(121) The optional nature of additional processors **1215** is denoted in FIG. **12** with broken lines. Each processor **1210**, **1215** may include one or more of the processing cores described herein and may be some version of the processor **1100**.

(122) The memory **1240** may be, for example, dynamic random access memory (DRAM), phase change memory (PCM), or a combination of the two. For at least one embodiment, the controller hub **1220** communicates with the processor(s) **1210**, **1215** via a multi-drop bus, such as a frontside bus (FSB), point-to-point interface such as QuickPath Interconnect (QPI), or similar connection **1295**.

(123) In one embodiment, the coprocessor **1245** is a special-purpose processor, such as, for example, a high-throughput MIC processor, a network or communication processor, compression engine, graphics processor, GPGPU, embedded processor, or the like. In one embodiment, controller hub **1220** may include an integrated graphics accelerator.

(124) There can be a variety of differences between the physical resources of the processors **1210**, **1215** in terms of a spectrum of metrics of merit including architectural, microarchitectural, thermal, power consumption characteristics, and the like.

(125) In one embodiment, the processor **1210** executes instructions that control data processing operations of a general type. Embedded within the instructions may be coprocessor instructions. The processor **1210** recognizes these coprocessor instructions as being of a type that should be executed by the attached coprocessor **1245**. Accordingly, the processor **1210** issues these coprocessor instructions (or control signals representing coprocessor instructions) on a coprocessor bus or other interconnect, to coprocessor **1245**. Coprocessor(s) **1245** accept and execute the received coprocessor instructions.

(126) Referring now to FIG. **13**, shown is a block diagram of a first more specific exemplary system **1300** in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention. As shown in FIG. **13**, multiprocessor system **1300** is a point-to-point interconnect system, and includes a first processor **1370** and a second processor **1380** coupled via a point-to-point interconnect **1350**. Each of processors **1370** and **1380** may be some version of the processor **1100**. In one embodiment of the invention, processors **1370** and **1380** are respectively processors **1210** and **1215**, while coprocessor **1338** is coprocessor **1245**. In another embodiment, processors **1370** and **1380** are respectively processor **1210** coprocessor **1245**.

(127) Processors **1370** and **1380** are shown including integrated memory controller (IMC) units **1372** and **1382**, respectively. Processor **1370** also includes as part of its bus controller units point-to-point (P-P) interfaces **1376** and **1378**; similarly, second processor **1380** includes P-P interfaces **1386** and **1388**. Processors **1370**, **1380** may exchange information via a point-to-point (P-P) interface **1350** using P-P interface circuits **1378**, **1388**. As shown in FIG. **13**, IMCs **1372** and **1382** couple the processors to respective memories, namely a memory **1332** and a memory **1334**, which may be portions of main memory locally attached to the respective processors.

(128) Processors **1370**, **1380** may each exchange information with a chipset **1390** via individual P-P interfaces **1352**, **1354** using point to point interface circuits **1376**, **1394**, **1386**, **1398**. Chipset **1390** may optionally exchange information with the coprocessor **1338** via a high-performance interface **1339** and an interface **1392**. In one embodiment, the coprocessor **1338** is a special-purpose processor, such as, for example, a high-throughput MIC processor, a network or communication processor, compression engine, graphics processor, GPGPU, embedded processor, or the like.

(129) A shared cache (not shown) may be included in either processor or outside of both processors, yet connected with the processors via P-P interconnect, such that either or both processors' local cache information may be stored in the shared cache if a processor is placed into a low power mode.

(130) Chipset **1390** may be coupled to a first bus **1316** via an interface **1396**. In one embodiment, first bus **1316** may be a Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) bus, or a bus such as a PCI Express bus or another third generation I/O interconnect bus, although the scope of the present invention is not so limited.

(131) As shown in FIG. **13**, various I/O devices **1314** may be coupled to first bus **1316**, along with a bus bridge **1318** which couples first bus **1316** to a second bus **1320**. In one embodiment, one or more additional processor(s) **1315**, such as coprocessors, high-throughput MIC processors, GPGPU's, accelerators (such as, e.g., graphics accelerators or digital signal processing (DSP) units), field programmable gate arrays, or any other processor, are coupled to first bus **1316**. In one embodiment, second bus **1320** may be a low pin count (LPC) bus. Various devices may be coupled to a second bus **1320** including, for example, a keyboard and/or mouse **1322**, communication devices **1327** and a storage unit **1328** such as a disk drive or other mass storage device which may include instructions/code and data **1330**, in one embodiment. Further, an audio I/O **1324** may be coupled to the second bus **1320**. Note that other architectures are possible. For example, instead of

the point-to-point architecture of FIG. 13, a system may implement a multi-drop bus or other such architecture.

(132) Referring now to FIG. 14, shown is a block diagram of a second more specific exemplary system 1400 in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention. Like elements in FIGS. 13 and 14 bear like reference numerals, and certain aspects of FIG. 13 have been omitted from FIG. 14 in order to avoid obscuring other aspects of FIG. 14.

(133) FIG. 14 illustrates that the processors 1370, 1380 may include integrated memory and I/O control logic ("CL") 1472 and 1482, respectively. Thus, the CL 1472, 1482 include integrated memory controller units and include I/O control logic. FIG. 14 illustrates that not only are the memories 1332, 1334 coupled to the CL 1472, 1482, but also that I/O devices 1414 are also coupled to the control logic 1472, 1482. Legacy I/O devices 1415 are coupled to the chipset 1390.

(134) Referring now to FIG. 15, shown is a block diagram of a SOC 1500 in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention. Similar elements in FIG. 15 bear like reference numerals. Also, dashed lined boxes are optional features on more advanced SOCs. In FIG. 15, an interconnect unit(s) 1502 is coupled to: an application processor 1510 which includes a set of one or more cores 1102A-N and shared cache unit(s) 1106; a system agent unit 1110; a bus controller unit(s) 1116; an integrated memory controller unit(s) 1114; a set or one or more coprocessors 1520 which may include integrated graphics logic, an image processor, an audio processor, and a video processor; an static random access memory (SRAM) unit 1530; a direct memory access (DMA) unit 1532; and a display unit 1540 for coupling to one or more external displays. In one embodiment, the coprocessor(s) 1520 include a special-purpose processor, such as, for example, a network or communication processor, compression engine, GPGPU, a high-throughput MIC processor, embedded processor, or the like.

(135) Embodiments of the mechanisms disclosed herein may be implemented in hardware, software, firmware, or a combination of such implementation approaches. Embodiments of the invention may be implemented as computer programs or program code executing on programmable systems comprising at least one processor, a storage system (including volatile and non-volatile memory and/or storage elements), at least one input device, and at least one output device.

(136) Program code, such as code 1330 illustrated in FIG. 13, may be applied to input instructions to perform the functions described herein and generate output information. The output information may be applied to one or more output devices, in known fashion. For purposes of this application, a processing system includes any system that has a processor, such as, for example; a digital signal processor (DSP), a microcontroller, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or a microprocessor.

(137) The program code may be implemented in a high level procedural or object oriented programming language to communicate with a processing system. The program code may also be implemented in assembly or machine language, if desired. In fact, the mechanisms described herein are not limited in scope to any particular programming language. In any case, the language may be a compiled or interpreted language.

(138) One or more aspects of at least one embodiment may be implemented by representative instructions stored on a machine-readable medium which represents various logic within the processor, which when read by a machine causes the machine to fabricate logic to perform the techniques described herein. Such representations, known as "IP cores" may be stored on a tangible, machine readable medium and supplied to various customers or manufacturing facilities to load into the fabrication machines that actually make the logic or processor.

(139) Such machine-readable storage media may include, without limitation, non-transitory, tangible arrangements of articles manufactured or formed by a machine or device, including storage media such as hard disks, any other type of disk including floppy disks, optical disks, compact disk read-only memories (CD-ROMs), compact disk rewritable's (CD-RWs), and magneto-optical disks, semiconductor devices such as read-only memories (ROMs), random access

memories (RAMs) such as dynamic random access memories (DRAMs), static random access memories (SRAMs), erasable programmable read-only memories (EPROMs), flash memories, electrically erasable programmable read-only memories (EEPROMs), phase change memory (PCM), magnetic or optical cards, or any other type of media suitable for storing electronic instructions.

(140) Accordingly, embodiments of the invention also include non-transitory, tangible machine-readable media containing instructions or containing design data, such as Hardware Description Language (HDL), which defines structures, circuits, apparatuses, processors and/or system features described herein. Such embodiments may also be referred to as program products.

Emulation (Including Binary Translation, Code Morphing, etc.)

(141) In some cases, an instruction converter may be used to convert an instruction from a source instruction set to a target instruction set. For example, the instruction converter may translate (e.g., using static binary translation, dynamic binary translation including dynamic compilation), morph, emulate, or otherwise convert an instruction to one or more other instructions to be processed by the core. The instruction converter may be implemented in software, hardware, firmware, or a combination thereof. The instruction converter may be on processor, off processor, or part on and part off processor.

(142) FIG. 16 is a block diagram contrasting the use of a software instruction converter to convert binary instructions in a source instruction set to binary instructions in a target instruction set according to embodiments of the invention. In the illustrated embodiment, the instruction converter is a software instruction converter, although alternatively the instruction converter may be implemented in software, firmware, hardware, or various combinations thereof. FIG. 16 shows a program in a high level language 1602 may be compiled using an x86 compiler 1604 to generate x86 binary code 1606 that may be natively executed by a processor with at least one x86 instruction set core 1616. The processor with at least one x86 instruction set core 1616 represents any processor that can perform substantially the same functions as an Intel processor with at least one x86 instruction set core by compatibly executing or otherwise processing (1) a substantial portion of the instruction set of the Intel x86 instruction set core or (2) object code versions of applications or other software targeted to run on an Intel processor with at least one x86 instruction set core, in order to achieve substantially the same result as an Intel processor with at least one x86 instruction set core. The x86 compiler 1604 represents a compiler that is operable to generate x86 binary code 1606 (e.g., object code) that can, with or without additional linkage processing, be executed on the processor with at least one x86 instruction set core 1616. Similarly, FIG. 16 shows the program in the high level language 1602 may be compiled using an alternative instruction set compiler 1608 to generate alternative instruction set binary code 1610 that may be natively executed by a processor without at least one x86 instruction set core 1614 (e.g., a processor with cores that execute the MIPS instruction set of MIPS Technologies of Sunnyvale, CA and/or that execute the ARM instruction set of ARM Holdings of Sunnyvale, CA). The instruction converter 1612 is used to convert the x86 binary code 1606 into code that may be natively executed by the processor without an x86 instruction set core 1614. This converted code is not likely to be the same as the alternative instruction set binary code 1610 because an instruction converter capable of this is difficult to make; however, the converted code will accomplish the general operation and be made up of instructions from the alternative instruction set. Thus, the instruction converter 1612 represents software, firmware, hardware, or a combination thereof that, through emulation, simulation or any other process, allows a processor or other electronic device that does not have an x86 instruction set processor or core to execute the x86 binary code 1606.

(143) Techniques and architectures for power management watchdog technology are described herein. In the above description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of certain embodiments. It will be apparent, however, to one skilled in the art that certain embodiments can be practiced without these specific details. In

other instances, structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid obscuring the description.

ADDITIONAL NOTES AND EXAMPLES

(144) Example 1 includes an integrated circuit, comprising a circuit block, and a power management circuit coupled to the circuit block to manage two or more power states for the circuit block and to manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, set a watchdog timer in response to the request, and monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state.

(145) Example 2 includes the integrated circuit of Example 1, wherein the power management circuit is further to report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(146) Example 3 includes the integrated circuit of Example 2, wherein the power management circuit is further to report an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(147) Example 4 includes the integrated circuit of Example 3, wherein the power management circuit is further to report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(148) Example 5 includes the integrated circuit of any of Examples 2 to 4, wherein the power management circuit is further to generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(149) Example 5A includes the integrated circuit of any of Examples 2 to 5, wherein the power management circuit is further to force the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.

(150) Example 6 includes the integrated circuit of any of Examples 1 to 5A, wherein the power management circuit is further to maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, and initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.

(151) Example 7 includes the integrated circuit of Example 6, wherein the power management circuit is further to decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.

(152) Example 8 includes a method, comprising managing two or more power states for a circuit block, managing a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, setting a watchdog timer in response to the request, and monitoring the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state.

(153) Example 9 includes the method of Example 8, further comprising reporting an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(154) Example 10 includes the method of Example 9, further comprising reporting an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(155) Example 11 includes the method of Example 10, further comprising reporting an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(156) Example 12 includes the method of any of Examples 9 to 11, further comprising generating an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(157) Example 12A includes the method of any of Examples 9 to 12, further comprising forcing the

circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.

(158) Example 13 includes the method of any of Examples 8 to 12A, further comprising maintaining a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, and initializing the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.

(159) Example 14 includes the method of Example 13, further comprising decrementing the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and generating an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.

(160) Example 15 includes an apparatus, comprising two or more circuit blocks co-located on a same substrate, and two or more power management circuits respectively coupled to the two or more circuit blocks, the two or more power management circuits to manage two or more power states for a circuit block coupled thereto and to manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, set a watchdog timer in response to the request, and monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state.

(161) Example 16 includes the apparatus of Example 15, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(162) Example 17 includes the apparatus of Example 16, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to report an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(163) Example 18 includes the apparatus of Example 17, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(164) Example 19 includes the apparatus of any of Examples 16 to 18, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(165) Example 19A includes the apparatus of any of Examples 16 to 19, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to force the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.

(166) Example 20 includes the apparatus of any of Examples 15 to 19A, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, and initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.

(167) Example 21 includes the apparatus of Example 20, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.

(168) Example 22 includes an apparatus, comprising means for managing two or more power states for a circuit block, means for managing a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, means for setting a watchdog timer in response to the request, and means for monitoring the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state.

(169) Example 23 includes the apparatus of Example 22, further comprising means for reporting an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(170) Example 24 includes the apparatus of Example 23, further comprising means for reporting an

identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(171) Example 25 includes the apparatus of Example 24, further comprising means for reporting an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(172) Example 26 includes the apparatus of any of Examples 23 to 25, further comprising means for generating an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(173) Example 26A includes the apparatus of any of Examples 23 to 26, further comprising means for forcing the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.

(174) Example 27 includes the apparatus of any of Examples 22 to 26A, further comprising means for maintaining a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, and means for initializing the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.

(175) Example 28 includes the apparatus of Example 27, further comprising means for decrementing the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and means for generating an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.

(176) Example 29 includes at least one non-transitory machine readable medium comprising a plurality of instructions that, in response to being executed on a computing device, cause the computing device to manage two or more power states for a circuit block, manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states, set a watchdog timer in response to the request, and monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state.

(177) Example 30 includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of Example 29, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(178) Example 31 includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of Example 30, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to report an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(179) Example 32 includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of Example 31, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(180) Example 33 includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of any of Examples 30 to 32, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

(181) Example 33A includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of any of Examples 30 to 32, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to force the circuit block to transition to the

requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.

(182) Example 34 includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of any of Examples 29 to 33A, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer, and initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.

(183) Example 35 includes the at least one non-transitory machine readable medium of Example 34, comprising a plurality of further instructions that, in response to being executed on the computing device, cause the computing device to decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state, and generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.

(184) Reference in the specification to “one embodiment” or “an embodiment” means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment is included in at least one embodiment of the invention. The appearances of the phrase “in one embodiment” in various places in the specification are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiment.

(185) Some portions of the detailed description herein are presented in terms of algorithms and symbolic representations of operations on data bits within a computer memory. These algorithmic descriptions and representations are the means used by those skilled in the computing arts to most effectively convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. An algorithm is here, and generally, conceived to be a self-consistent sequence of steps leading to a desired result. The steps are those requiring physical manipulations of physical quantities. Usually, though not necessarily, these quantities take the form of electrical or magnetic signals capable of being stored, transferred, combined, compared, and otherwise manipulated. It has proven convenient at times, principally for reasons of common usage, to refer to these signals as bits, values, elements, symbols, characters, terms, numbers, or the like.

(186) It should be borne in mind, however, that all of these and similar terms are to be associated with the appropriate physical quantities and are merely convenient labels applied to these quantities. Unless specifically stated otherwise as apparent from the discussion herein, it is appreciated that throughout the description, discussions utilizing terms such as “processing” or “computing” or “calculating” or “determining” or “displaying” or the like, refer to the action and processes of a computer system, or similar electronic computing device, that manipulates and transforms data represented as physical (electronic) quantities within the computer system's registers and memories into other data similarly represented as physical quantities within the computer system memories or registers or other such information storage, transmission or display devices.

(187) Certain embodiments also relate to apparatus for performing the operations herein. This apparatus may be specially constructed for the required purposes, or it may comprise a general purpose computer selectively activated or reconfigured by a computer program stored in the computer. Such a computer program may be stored in a computer readable storage medium, such as, but is not limited to, any type of disk including floppy disks, optical disks, CD-ROMs, and magnetic-optical disks, read-only memories (ROMs), random access memories (RAMs) such as dynamic RAM (DRAM), EPROMs, EEPROMs, magnetic or optical cards, or any type of media suitable for storing electronic instructions, and coupled to a computer system bus.

(188) The algorithms and displays presented herein are not inherently related to any particular computer or other apparatus. Various general purpose systems may be used with programs in accordance with the teachings herein, or it may prove convenient to construct more specialized apparatus to perform the required method steps. The required structure for a variety of these systems will appear from the description herein. In addition, certain embodiments are not described

with reference to any particular programming language. It will be appreciated that a variety of programming languages may be used to implement the teachings of such embodiments as described herein.

(189) Besides what is described herein, various modifications may be made to the disclosed embodiments and implementations thereof without departing from their scope. Therefore, the illustrations and examples herein should be construed in an illustrative, and not a restrictive sense. The scope of the invention should be measured solely by reference to the claims that follow.

Claims

1. An integrated circuit, comprising: a circuit block; and a power management circuit coupled to the circuit block to: manage two or more power states for the circuit block and to manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states; set a watchdog timer in response to the request; monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state; maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer; decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state; and generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.
2. The integrated circuit of claim 1, wherein the power management circuit is further to: report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
3. The integrated circuit of claim 2, wherein the power management circuit is further to: report an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
4. The integrated circuit of claim 3, wherein the power management circuit is further to: report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
5. The integrated circuit of claim 2, wherein the power management circuit is further to: generate the interrupt to the operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
6. The integrated circuit of claim 2, wherein the power management circuit is further to: force the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.
7. The integrated circuit of claim 1, wherein the power management circuit is further to initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.
8. A method, comprising: managing two or more power states for a circuit block; managing a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states; setting a watchdog timer in response to the request; monitoring the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state; maintaining a timeout counter for the watchdog timer; decrementing the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state; and generating an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.
9. The method of claim 8, further comprising: reporting an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
10. The method of claim 9, further comprising: reporting an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.

11. The method of claim 10, further comprising: reporting an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
 12. The method of claim 9, further comprising: generating the interrupt to the operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
 13. The method of claim 9, further comprising: forcing the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.
 14. The method of claim 8, further comprising: initializing the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.
 15. An apparatus, comprising: two or more circuit blocks co-located on a same substrate; and two or more power management circuits respectively coupled to the two or more circuit blocks, the two or more power management circuits to: manage two or more power states for a circuit block coupled thereto and to manage a request for the circuit block to enter a requested power state of the two or more power states; set a watchdog timer in response to the request; monitor the watchdog timer and a transition of the circuit block from a current power state to the requested power state; maintain a timeout counter for the watchdog timer; decrement the timeout counter if the current power state of the circuit block has not reached the requested power state; and generate an interrupt to an operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the timeout counter reaches an expiration value.
 16. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to: report an indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
 17. The apparatus of claim 16, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to: report an identification of the circuit block together with the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
 18. The apparatus of claim 17, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to: report an indication of the current power state of the circuit block and the requested power state together with the identification of the circuit block and the indication that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
 19. The apparatus of claim 16, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to: generate the interrupt to the operating system power manager that indicates that the transition to the requested power state failed if the watchdog timer expires.
 20. The apparatus of claim 16, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to: force the circuit block to transition to the requested power state after a threshold number of watchdog timer expirations.
 21. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the two or more power management circuits are further to: initialize the timeout counter to a value indicated along with the request for the circuit block to enter the requested power state.
-